

Visit Bucket Methodology

Pre-filter applied to all visits: dropped any visit with fewer than 2 user actions to remove bots and accidental landings. The monthly view further excludes weekends.

Each visit is assigned to exactly one category using a first-match precedence rule. Categories are checked in order — once a visit matches, it stops. For Office Clerk and CAD Designer, the visitor must have placed zero orders in the analysis window (visitor-level check). Summaries below are sorted by share of total; the detailed definitions that follow are in precedence order.

April 15, 2026

Category	Visits	%
Search User	388,746	66.06%
Independent	51,878	8.82%
CAD Designer	38,394	6.53%
Centralized Buyer	32,725	5.56%
Shared Login	29,174	4.96%
Account Curious	28,883	4.91%
Multi-Platform	15,522	2.64%
Office Clerk	3,116	0.53%
Total	588,438	100.0%

April 1 – 30, 2026, excluding weekends

Category	Visits	%	Logged in?
Search User	5,646,633	58.18%	N
Independent	968,861	9.98%	Y
Multi-Platform	752,656	7.76%	Y
CAD Designer	702,858	7.24%	N
Account Curious	573,514	5.91%	Y
Centralized Buyer	553,503	5.70%	Y
Shared Login	497,354	5.13%	Y
Office Clerk	10,237	0.11%	Y
Total	9,705,616	100.0%	

Category Definitions (in Precedence Order)

1. Office Clerk

The office person who handles paperwork on behalf of orderers. They never place orders themselves; they download invoices, packing slips, material certificates, and check tracking numbers for orders that other people in their company placed.

How we identified them: the visit had post-order success activity (any document download, tracking lookup, or cert save), did not place an order this visit, AND the visitor placed zero orders anywhere in the analysis window.

Why first: downloading order documents is a highly specific behavior — if you see it, this is what they came for.

2. CAD Designer

The engineer or product designer who comes to McMaster to grab CAD models for parts they're designing into a product. They may never order through McMaster.

How we identified them: the visit had at least one successful CAD download, did not place an order this visit, AND the visitor placed zero orders anywhere in the analysis window.

Why second: saving CAD is a specific behavioral signal of intent. Wins over customer-profile labels because the persona is defined by behavior, not customer state.

3. Search User

The person who uses McMaster as a reference catalog to browse, copy part numbers, print pages, or forward info to a colleague. They are not logged in at the time of visit.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is either missing entirely (never touched the order pad), or has no contact record attached (touched the order pad but never ordered).

Why third: once we've ruled out the specific behavior buckets, anyone without a customer record is functionally a search user.

4. Account Curious

The person who created a McMaster login but has never placed an order and is not linked to a CMF.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has at least one contact record, but that contact has zero ship-to locations on file, AND the visit didn't place an order today.

Why fourth: sits between Search and the real-customer buckets — they're more than a search user (they have a login) but not yet a real customer (no ship-to).

5. Multi-Platform User

The same person showing up across multiple McMaster platforms — mcmaster.com, the iPhone app, mobile web, punchout, etc.

How we identified them: the visitor_id appeared on 2 or more distinct platforms within the analysis window.

Why fifth: this is a person-level behavior pattern, weaker than visit-level behavior. Sits above the customer-profile buckets because cross-platform use is more interesting than profile alone.

6. Shared Login

Multiple people at the same company share a single McMaster login. They might each place their own orders but use the same account credentials and shared order pad.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is linked to 2 or more distinct contact records — meaning multiple real people have ordered under the same login. This is exactly how the data warehouse encodes shared accounts.

Why sixth: customer-profile signal, deferred behind visit-level and person-level behaviors above.

7. Centralized Buyer

One person who places orders for many ship-to locations.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor is linked to exactly 1 contact record (one login, not shared), and that contact has shipped to 2 or more distinct locations historically.

Why seventh: customer-profile signal, requires single-login plus multi-location.

8. Independent / Individual User

One person with their own McMaster login, ordering parts to one location. This is the persona that our website is optimized for.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has exactly 1 contact and 1 ship-to location, OR the visit didn't match any earlier bucket. Includes a small group of first-time orderers whose ship-to record hasn't been fully built yet.

Why last: by design, this is the catch-all for normal-customer visits.